

Career Literacy Foundations



Student Workbook

Name:

VANCOUVER
COMMUNITY
COLLEGE

Career Literacy Foundations Student Workbook

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Vancouver Community College
2017

Acknowledgments

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Workplace Communication

A. List the four styles of communication.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

B. Label each response.

You are hooking up cable TV for a customer. The customer offers to pay you \$20 to give them free channels without telling the cable company. Read each response. Decide if the response is passive, aggressive, passive-aggressive, or assertive.

1 - You rip the \$20 bill in half and throw it on the floor.

2 - You say, "I know it's nice to have free channels, but my job is important to me and I need to follow the rules."

3 - You do what the customer asks even though you are afraid you may lose your job.

4 - You refuse to do what the customer asks - and set up the cable TV so that some of the channels they pay for are blurry.

C. Pros and Cons

In your opinion, what are the pros and cons of being **passive**?

In your opinion, what are the pros and cons of being **aggressive**?

In your opinion, what are the pros and cons of being **assertive**?



D. Active Listening Do's and Don'ts

Use your answers from the Active Listening Card Sort to fill in this chart.

Do's	Don'ts

E. Make an I Statement

You are working as a baker. You and your co-worker made a tasty new muffin recipe together. Your boss loved it! But your co-worker took all the credit.

Later on, you will speak privately to your co-worker. Make an I Statement you could use in this case.

I feel _____ when you _____

The effect is _____

Would you be open to _____



Teamwork

A. My Favourite Teamwork Quote

Copy your favourite teamwork quote from the *Unscramble the Quote* activity.

What does this quote mean to you?



B. The Marshmallow Challenge

Reflect on how your team worked together during the marshmallow challenge.

Difficulties of Team Work What were some of the difficulties of working together?	Strategies for Working Together What teamwork strategies helped your group do well? What would you do differently next time?

Personality Differences

We all have different tastes in terms of the kinds of people we like to work with and the kinds of people we don't like to work with. It's good to be aware of our preferences so we can be ready for the possibility that we will have to work well with people whose personalities clash with our own. This is often one of the hardest parts of any job.

C. Pick five traits from the box for each list below.

Confident	Snobby	Good listener
Positive	Real	Full of oneself
Polite	Impatient	Disrespectful
Negative	Rude	Open-minded
Bossy	Patient	Hateful
Helpful	Dishonest	Whiny
Very sensitive	Don't compete	Caring
Selfish	Lazy	Sarcastic
Warm	Friendly	Attention-seeking

Most Preferred Personality Traits in a Team Member

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Least Preferred Personality Traits in a Team Member

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

D. Working Together Across Differences

What can you do to build a relationship with someone whose personality clashes with your own?

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Dealing with Conflict

A. List the five ways of dealing with conflict.



1. _____



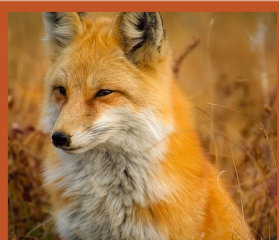
2. _____



3. _____



4. _____



5. _____

B. My Approach to Conflict

I am a...

- ☐ Turtle
- ☐ Teddy Bear
- ☐ Shark
- ☐ Owl
- ☐ Fox

This means that I tend to...

The advantages of this approach are...

The disadvantages of this approach are...

C. Reflect on the *It's a What?!* activity. Answer these questions.

How do stress and pressure affect our ability to work together?

D. Choose one of the strategies from the handout about dealing with conflict. Answer the questions below.

Explain what this strategy is in your own words.

Why is this strategy helpful in times of conflict?

E. Angry Outbursts

Describe a time when someone had an angry outburst at you. Pick something that is not triggering for you.

How did you react?

What other strategies could you have used to cool down the situation?



Time Management

A. Do you procrastinate on any of these tasks?



- ☐ Going to the doctor for a check up
- ☐ Paying bills
- ☐ Answering email



- ☐ Leaving on time for work or school
- ☐ Doing homework
- ☐ Cleaning the house



- ☐ Getting exercise
- ☐ Doing the laundry
- ☐ Doing the dishes



- ☐ Going to bed at a reasonable time
- ☐ Grocery shopping



- ☐ Taking out the garbage
- ☐ Getting a hair cut
- ☐ Other? _____

B. “I choose to” instead of “I have to”

Nobody likes to do a task just because they “have to.” It can be helpful to decide to see these tasks as choices and remember why they are important.

Pick three tasks that you have to do, but tend to avoid. You can pick tasks the previous list or think of your own. Then, complete these sentences:

I choose to _____

because _____

I choose to _____

because _____

I choose to _____

because _____

C. Dealing with Excuses

People often delay doing tasks that they *have* to do but don't *want* to do. Look at these common excuses for not doing tasks. Think of some strategies for dealing with each excuse.

Excuse	Strategies
"I don't feel like doing it." eg. "I don't feel like going to school, so I'll stay home today and go tomorrow."	
"I don't know how." eg. "I don't know how to do my taxes, so I'll do them later."	
"I might not do it well enough." eg. "I might not do well in that training course, so maybe I'll sign up later."	
"This is boring." eg. "This homework is boring, so I'll just do it later."	
"You can't tell me what to do." eg. "When you tell me I should quit smoking, it makes me want to smoke even more!"	

D. To-Do List

Make a list of all the tasks you need to complete this week.

Decide if each item on your list is an A, B, or C:

A - Important and urgent

B - Important but not urgent

C - Small and not urgent

A, B, C	To Do

Do the A tasks first, then the B tasks, and then the C tasks.



Training Experience

A. Which training will you complete?



☐ FoodSafe

☐ Serving It Right



☐ First Aid

☐ CPR

☐ WHMIS



☐ Fall Protection

☐ Driver's License

☐ Fire extinguisher



☐ Other? _____

Why did you pick this training?

B. Researching Training Programs

Program Name	Who delivers the training?	Where does the training take place?	When is the training?	How much does it cost?

Which program will you complete?

Who can you ask to support you with funding? Write down the address, too.

When will you ask them?

C. Common Roadblocks to Learning

Roadblock	Strategies
I have a hard time paying attention in class.	
I have a hard time memorizing information.	
I feel so nervous when I write tests that I can't think.	
I don't want to ask questions when I am stuck because I don't want to look stupid.	
I have a hard time motivating myself to study.	

D. Training Reflection

Answer the questions below based on your experience of the training.

Look at your Professionalism handout. Which of these things did you do especially well?

Is there anything you could improve on next time?

What strategies did you use to learn during the training?

Working in a Diverse Society

A. The Power Flower

Look at the power flower. There are two rings of petals, an inside ring and an outside ring. With your classmates, discuss any words you do not know.

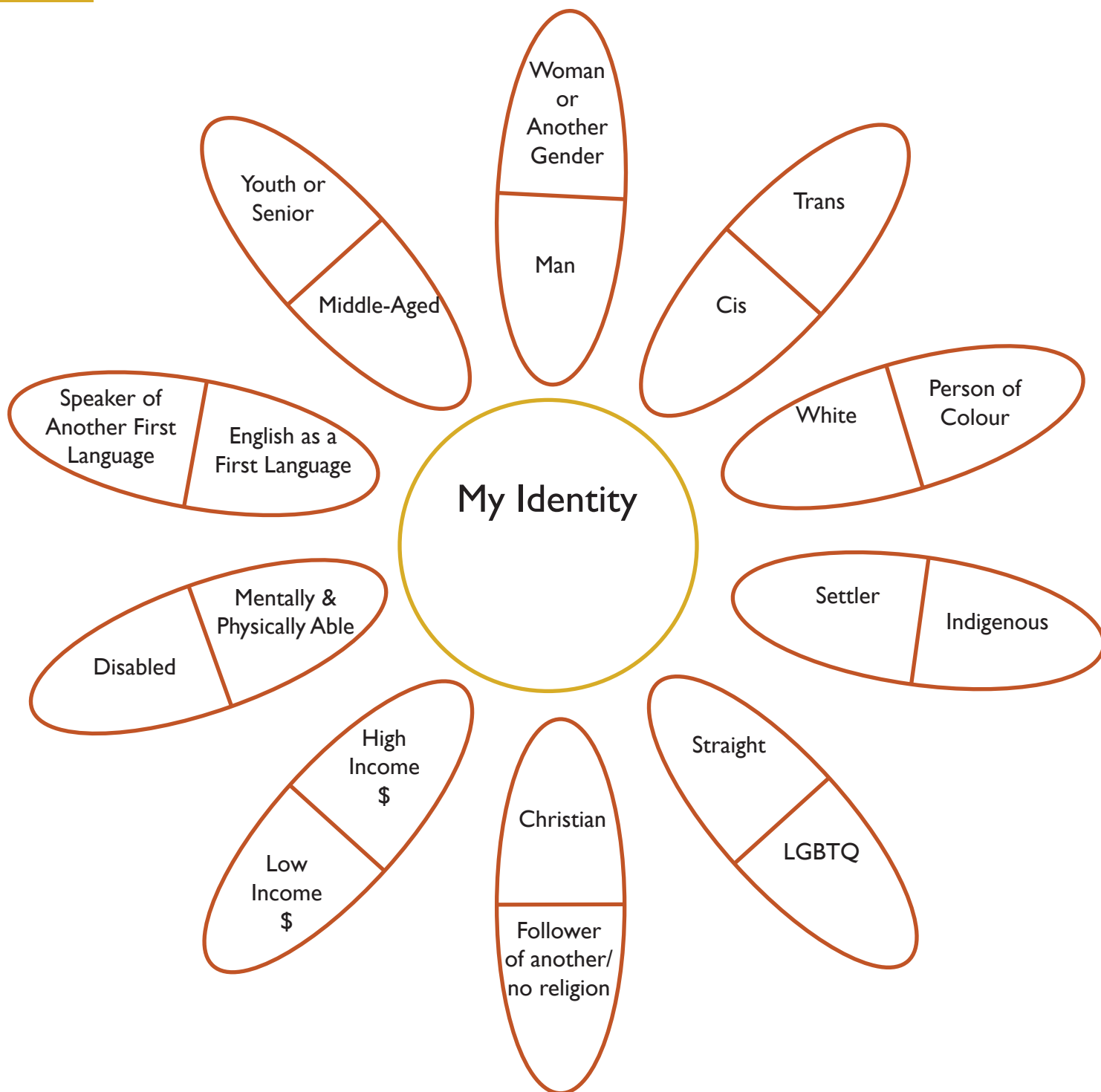
Which ring do you think faces the most prejudice (inside or outside)? How do you know?

Most people face prejudice in at least some ways. Do any petals on the outside ring describe you? Name any you feel comfortable sharing.

The word 'privilege' is often used to describe the ways we do not have to worry about being a target of the most harmful kinds of prejudice that can prevent us from getting a job, finding housing, making a fair wage, being safe from hate crimes, and getting our needs met by schools, the police, healthcare workers, and so on.

Do any of the petals on the inside ring describe you? Name any you feel comfortable sharing (even if you aren't sure that it counts as privilege).

The Power Flower



B. Experiences of Prejudice

Pick **one** part of your identity from the outside ring.

Answer yes, no, or not sure for these questions:

Are there stereotypes about people in my group being weak or stupid or disgusting or dangerous? _____

When I go somewhere new, do I often worry people might treat me poorly because I am a member of this group? _____

Have I often feared for my safety just because I am a member of this group? _____

Is it true that people from my group are less likely to have powerful positions in government? _____

Is it uncommon to see members of my group be main characters in books, films, or TV shows? _____

Is it more common for people in my group to be poor for reasons we often can't control? _____

How does it feel to experience prejudice?

What gives you hope? _____

C. Thinking about Our Privilege

It is common to feel defensive about the ways we have privilege. It is important to think carefully about our privilege so our feelings don't get in the way of being fair and obeying the law at work.

This is an activity to help us think about whether our privilege is real. Pick **one** part of your identity from the inside ring. Answer yes, no, or not sure for these questions:

Are there stereotypes about people in my group being weak or stupid or disgusting or dangerous?

When I go somewhere new, do I often worry people might treat me poorly because I am a member of this group?

Have I often feared for my safety just because I am a member of this group?

Is it true that people from my group are less likely to have powerful positions in government?

Is it uncommon to see members of my group be main characters in books, films, or TV shows?

Am I less likely to be able to meet my basic needs like food and housing than people not in my group?

Based on your answers, does this part of your identity give you an advantage over people who don't share this identity? Explain.

D. Where Do Our Prejudices Come From?

Are there any groups on the outside ring that you tend to dislike? For the wellbeing of the class, do not write them down or say them out loud. Just notice for yourself. Try to be honest with yourself about the prejudices you hold.

There are many reasons why we are prejudiced. Think about one group you are prejudiced towards. Check any reasons you think might have led you to be prejudiced against this group:

- ☐ I've never been friends or family with a person from this group.
- ☐ I hang out with people who also dislike this group.
- ☐ I haven't seen many positive examples of people from this group in TV, films, news, and books.
- ☐ I've heard bad things about people from this group (they are sick, weak, not smart, or dangerous, etc)
- ☐ The information I have about this group may not be correct or tell the whole story.
- ☐ I may not know enough about this group to judge them fairly.
- ☐ It makes me feel better about myself when I put down people in this group.
- ☐ I think I am better than people in this group.
- ☐ I worry about what other people will think of me if I show acceptance of this group.
- ☐ I worry that this group will make my community unsafe.
- ☐ I worry that this group will make my community less moral.
- ☐ I am afraid this group will change my community and I won't feel like I belong.

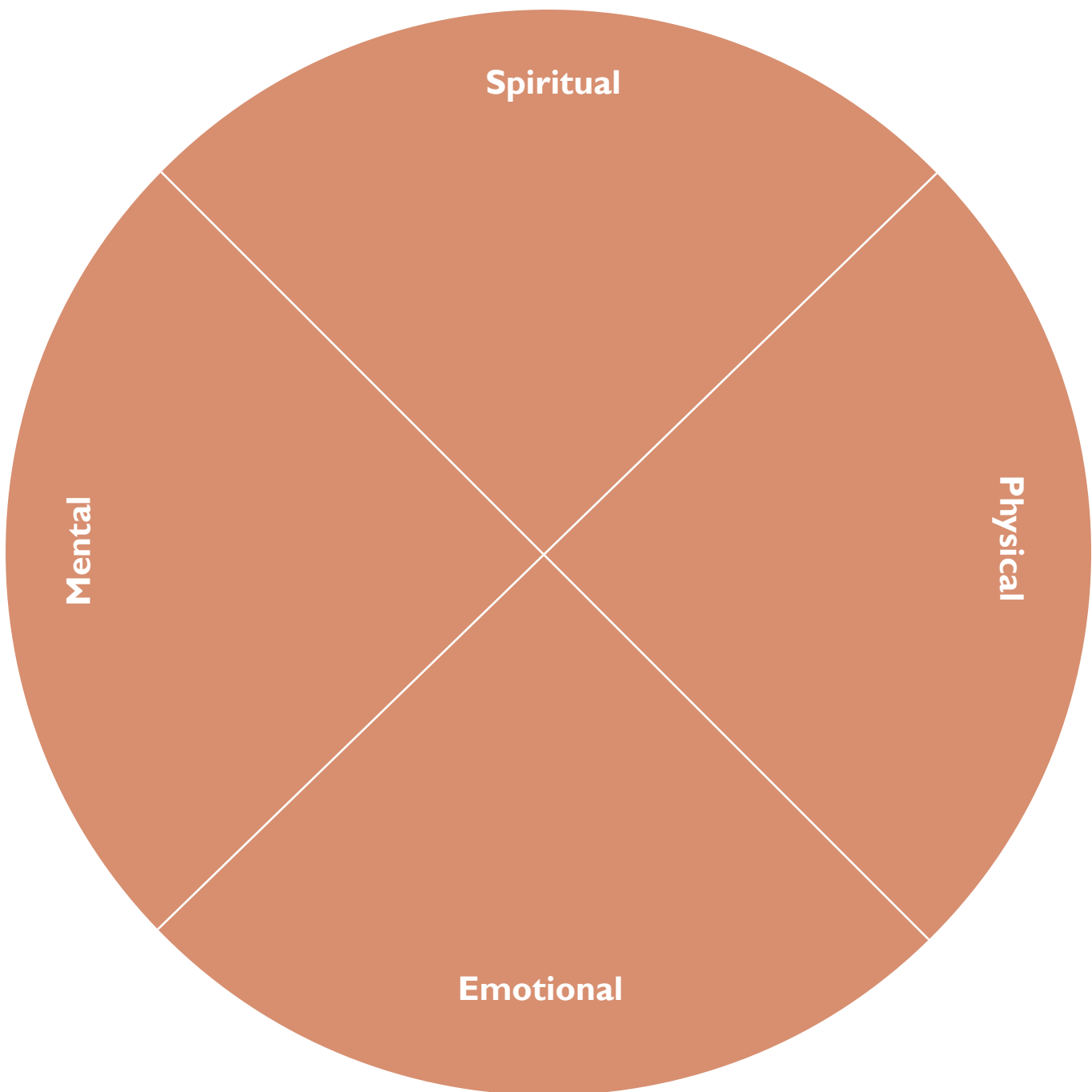
E. Unlearning Prejudice

We cannot speak or act in prejudiced ways at work. Think of at least two reasons for this.

What are some ways we could unlearn our prejudices?

Personal Wellness

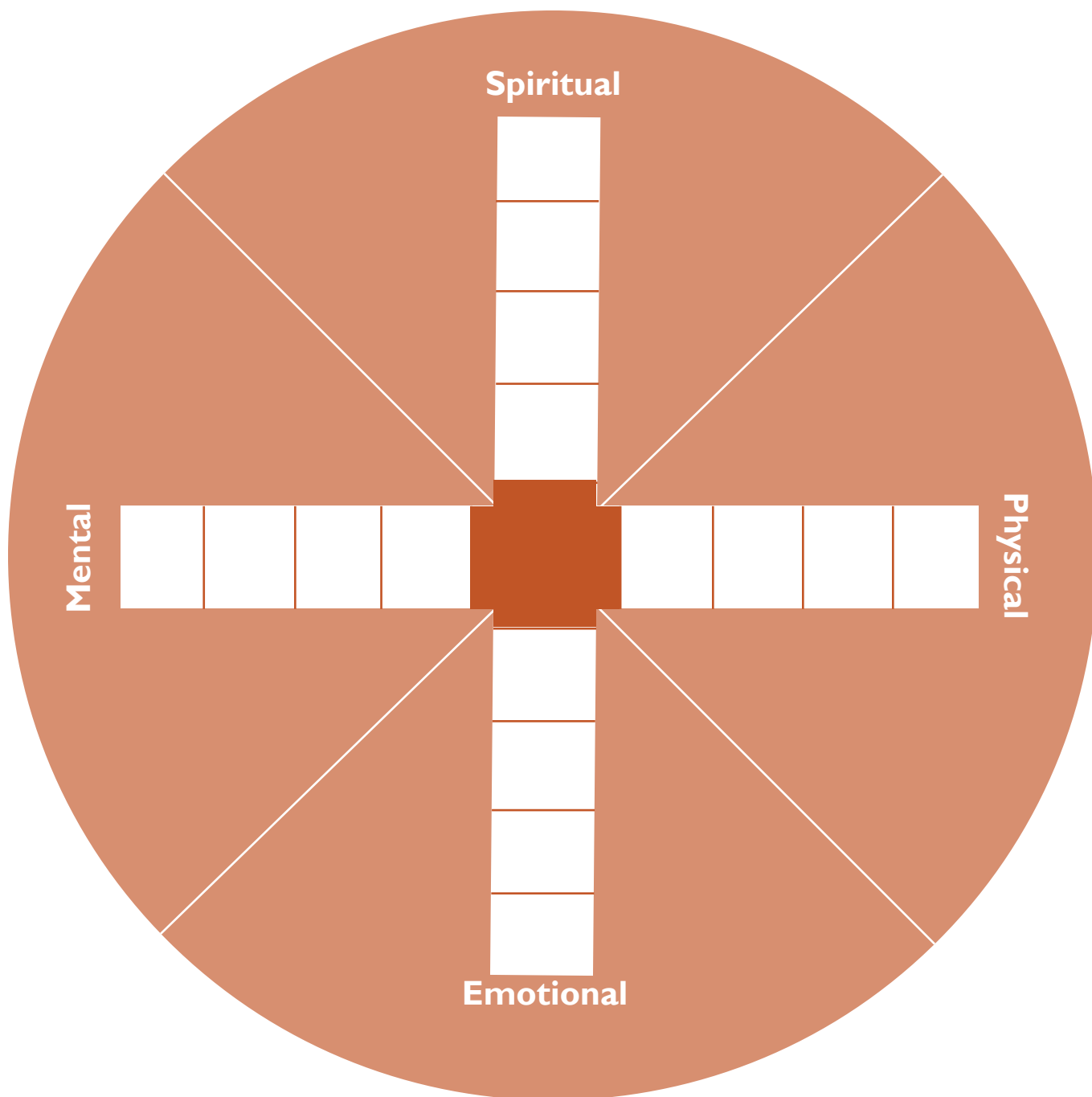
A. What am I doing now to support my wellbeing?



This activity is adapted from Margot Loiselle and Laretta Mackenzie's article "The Wellness Wheel: An Aboriginal Contribution to Social Work" accessed from <http://www.reseaudialog.qc.ca/Docspdf/LoiselleMcKenzie.pdf>.

B. Make a Graph

Count how many items you wrote in your spiritual quadrant on the opposite page. Shade in a box for each one in the graph below. Repeat for each quadrant. What needs more attention to reach balance?



C. Physical Wellbeing

Question	Response
How is my physical health?	
What are my physical and material needs right now?	

D. Emotional Wellbeing

Question	Response
Do I feel good about myself?	
Am I working on having healthy relationships?	
What do I feel about the future?	

These questions are adapted from Margot Loiselle and Laretta Mackenzie's article "The Wellness Wheel: An Aboriginal Contribution to Social Work" accessed from <http://www.reseaudialog.qc.ca/Docspdf/LoiselleMcKenzie.pdf>.

E. Mental Wellbeing

Question	Response
What is my self-talk usually like?	
What do I enjoy that stimulates my mind?	
What are my creative abilities?	

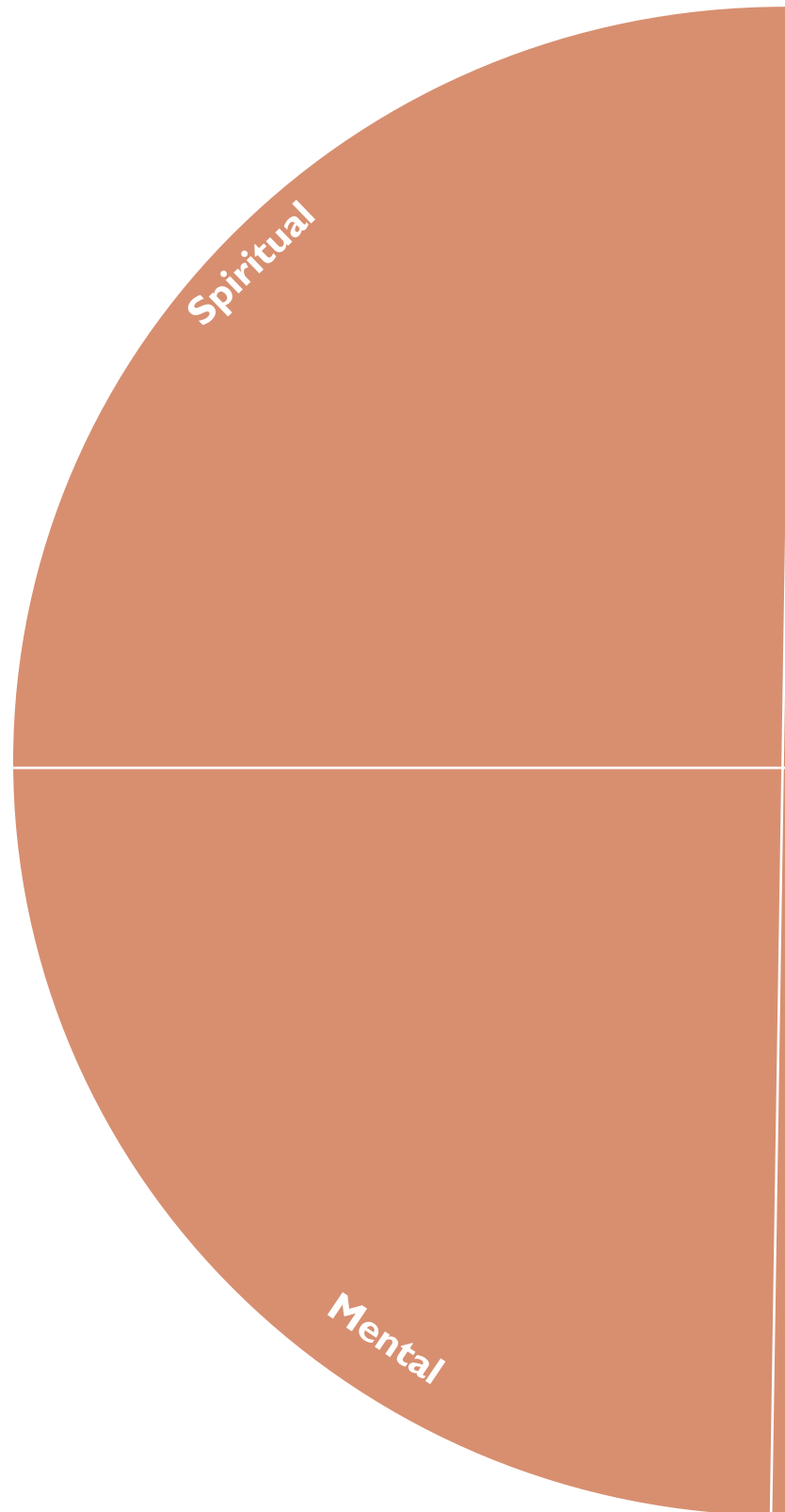
F. Spiritual Wellbeing

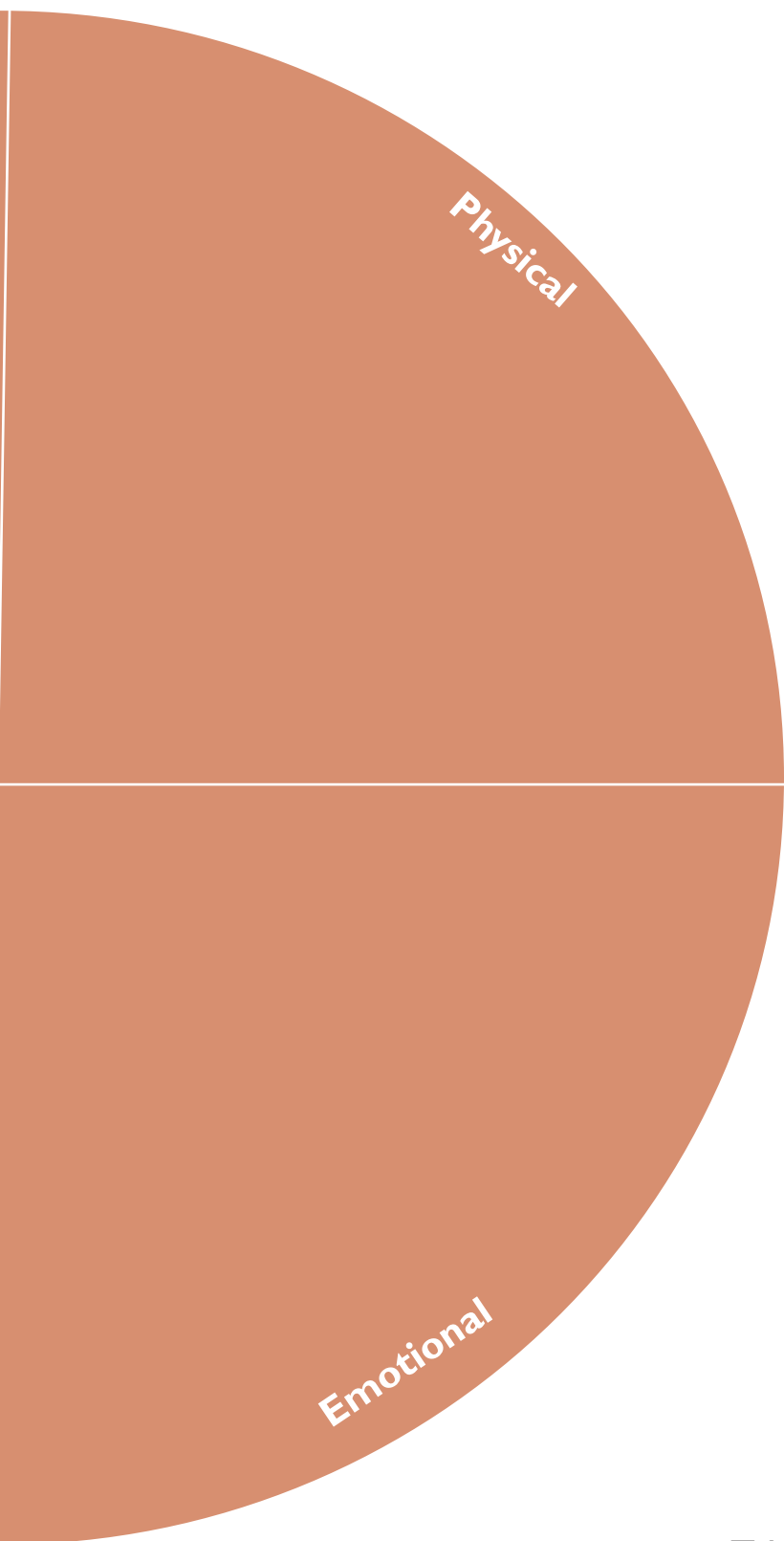
Question	Response
Do I take time out for spiritual or religious practices?	
Do I have a grateful attitude towards life?	
Do I live up to my beliefs and values?	

These questions are adapted from Margot Loiselle and Laretta Mackenzie's article "The Wellness Wheel: An Aboriginal Contribution to Social Work" accessed from <http://www.reseaudialog.qc.ca/Docspdf/LoiselleMcKenzie.pdf>.

G. Personal Wellness Wheel

What positive activities can I do to improve my wellbeing in each area?
What harmful activities must I avoid?





Take care to have balance in all four areas.

Budgeting

A. Financial Goals

Think of something you would like to save up to buy.

How much does this item cost?

If you set aside \$20 each month, how many months would it take you to save enough to buy this item?

Item cost divided by \$20 = Number of months

_____ = _____

Divide this number by 12 to get the number of years: _____

B. Make a Monthly Budget

Income	Amount
Total Income	
Expenses	Amount
Rent	
Utilities (Electricity, Hydro)	
Groceries	
Household Items	
Child Care	
Transportation	
Medical Expenses	
Phone	
Internet, Cable TV	
Entertainment	
Pet Expenses	
Hair Cuts	
Clothing	
Laundry	
Debt Payment	
Gifts	
Lottery, Gaming, Bingo	
Cigarettes, Alcohol, Drugs,	
Savings	
Total Expenses	

C. At the Grocery Store

Watch the clip from *Stuff You Should Know*. Think of the best word to complete each sentence.

1. Put on headphones and play upbeat _____ so you don't linger.
2. Shop from the _____ ring of the store and avoid the expensive inner aisles.
3. Go with a shopping _____ so you don't browse.
4. Look at items on the _____ and _____ shelves, not just the expensive shelves at eye-level.
5. Don't shop when you are _____ or you may buy things you don't need.
6. Decide whether or not you need a _____, a basket, or neither so you don't buy things just to fill up the space.

Compare your words with a partner.
Then discuss which tips you like best and why.

D. How Much Would You Save?

Think of something you often buy that you would consider giving up to save money. Let's find out how much you would save per year if you gave it up!

Item you might give up: _____

Cost of one of these items: _____

About how many days per week do you buy this item? _____

How much do you spend on this item per week?

Multiply the above two numbers. _____

How much do you spend on this item per year?

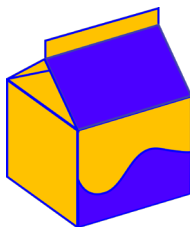
Multiply your last answer by 52 (for 52 weeks in a year). _____

E. Finding the Better Buy

Which item do you think is the better buy? Show how you know.



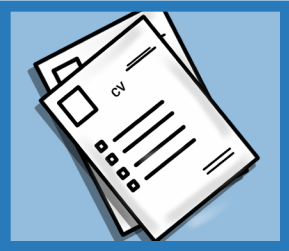
500 mL of milk for \$2.25



250 mL of milk for \$1.25

The Job Search Process

A. What are the steps of the job search process?



☐ _____

☐ _____



☐ _____

☐ _____



☐ _____

☐ _____



☐ _____

☐ _____

B. Building a Network

These people can help you learn more about the career you want to go into.

**People I know who
work in fields I am
interested in:**

**People I know who
know lots of other
people:**

These people might be able to put you in touch with people you might not otherwise have the chance to meet,

**People I have
worked/volunteered
with in the past:**

These people could be a reference for you.

The Job Search Process

C. Employment Resources in Your Community

Search the Internet for 2-4 employment resource centers in your community. Fill out this chart.

	Organization One:
Address	
Phone Number	
What Do They Offer?	

	Organization Two:
Address	
Phone Number	
What Do They Offer?	

	Organization Three:
Address	
Phone Number	
What Do They Offer?	

	Organization Four:
Address	
Phone Number	
What Do They Offer?	

Your Resume

A. Read a Resume

What information goes at the top of a resume? Name 4 things.

What is a job objective?

How would you choose which skills to highlight?

How do you know what to put first under Work Experience and Education/Training?

Why might it be helpful to put your interests on your resume?

Sara Khan
23-876 E. Hastings St.
Vancouver, BC V6A 1T3
skhan@gmail.com
778 555 5555

Job Objective: Health Care Aide

Highlights of Skills

- Certified Health Care Aide committed to patient care and comfort
- Proven clerical abilities such as charting and taking inventory of supplies
- Friendly and professional with patients and co-workers
- Trained in First Aid, CPR, Foodsafe, and WHIMIS
- Fluent in English and Farsi

Work Experience

2015 - 2017	Peer Support Worker Raincity Housing Vancouver, BC
2012-2013	Volunteer Vancouver Native Health Society Vancouver, BC

Education/Training

2019	Health Care Assistant Program Vancouver Community College
2018	Basic Education Program Vancouver Community College
2015 - 2017	On-the-job training Raincity Housing

Interests

The Multicultural Community Kitchen, and The DTES Women's Choir

References

Available on request

B. Write your resume. Follow the example on the last page.

Job Objective: _____

Highlights of Skills

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Work Experience

Education/Training

Interests:

Available upon request

Your Cover Letter

A. Put the parts of a cover letter in the correct order.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

Ask for an interview

Say what job your are applying for

Date

Your name and contact info

Closing

Employer's address

Greeting

Say how you are fit for the job

Your signature and name

Say why you want the job

Li Min

① 958 East Pender St.
Vancouver, BC V6A 4B4
604 555 5555
li.min@gmail.com

② March 9, 2018

③ Mr. Dev Neel
ABC Dental Office
23 Commercial Drive
Vancouver, BC V5A 4T9

④ Dear Mr. Neel,

⑤ I am pleased to submit my application for the position of dental hygienist at ABC Dental Office.

⑥ I am interested in working at ABC Dental because I share your commitment to serving multicultural clients in a variety of languages. My family is from Hong Kong and I know how helpful it can be to receive health care in one's first language.

⑦ I just completed the Dental Hygiene program at Vancouver Community College. I had the opportunity to practice my skills working with the public at the VCC Dental Clinic. My instructors praised me for my caring personality, ability to work accurately, and my time management skills. I believe I will be a good fit at ABC Dental Office because I am very enthusiastic about starting my career and can provide services in both English and Cantonese.

⑧ I hope you will contact me to set up an interview. My resume is attached. I look forward to hearing from you.

⑨ Sincerely,

Li Min

⑩

Li Min

B. Your Cover Letter

1

2

3

4

5 6 7 8

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Your Job Interview

A. What do you remember from “6 Tips to Ace a Job Interview”?

Good Appearance: Name some tips for choosing clothes, accessories, and makeup.

Be Punctual: How early should you be? What can you do to make sure you arrive on time?

Sell Yourself: Name a few items you might bring with you on the interview to sell yourself.

Body Gestures: Describe your face, handshake, eye contact, hand gestures, and posture.

Ask Questions: Why should you ask questions at the end of your interview?

Follow Up: What are some things you could do after an interview?

B. Watch the video “8 Common Interview Questions and Answers.” Decide how you would respond. Practice with a partner.

Tell me about yourself.

What are your strengths?

What are your weaknesses?

Where do you see yourself in five years? Or what are your goals?

If an employer asks, “What do you know about our company?”, what kind of information could you give?

How well do you handle change? Think of an example from your life.

How well do you work under pressure? Think of an example from your life.

How do you make important decisions?

Personality Inventory

What do people like most about you?

I can be trusted

I am a good listener

I can solve problems

I am fun

What best describes you?

I am in control of my feelings

I have a lot of feelings

I am cool and calm

I am upbeat

When you are on a team, you are the one who...

Helps keep things organized

Helps everyone get along

Comes up with ideas

Encourages people

Which of these things stresses you out most?	Mess	Not being allowed to be myself
	Feeling like I'm not good enough at something	Being told what to do

How do you make decisions?	I do what is expected of me by family, friends, my boss, and my community	I follow my heart
	I think about the pros and cons and do what makes sense	I often do the first thing that comes to mind

What are you like when you feel stressed?	I get moody and bossy	I dwell on things
	I think bad thoughts about myself or others	I can be rude or angry

What is the most important thing about you?	I am responsible	I am kind
	I am smart	I am brave

What do you need most?	To protect myself and my family	To care for people and feel accepted
	To learn new things	To try new things

What is most important to you?	My culture and heritage	My relationships with people
	Understanding the world	Living life to the fullest

Which of these things makes you feel like doing work?	The feeling of a job well done	Growing into the best person I can be
	Finding new and better ways to do something	Competition

How do you like to spend your free time?	I like to join clubs or groups	I like to find beauty in art, books, and nature
	I like alone time	I like to play sports

How would you prefer to spend a work day?	Following a routine	Helping people
	Being challenged	Doing many different things

What are you best at?	I am good with details and I can follow a plan	I am good with people
	I can see the big picture and create my own way to get something done	I am good with my hands

I want to work with people who	Behave	Get along
	Do good work	Are fun to be around

Personality Inventory Results

Count up the number of X's on each colour	Gold: _____	Blue: _____
	Green: _____	Orange: _____

Put your colours in order from highest to lowest:

Personality Inventory Reflection

Read the **Strengths** section for your personality type.
Choose the strengths from the list that best describe you.
Make a list of your strengths below:

What strengths do you think are missing from your list? Add them above.

Talk with a partner:

- Choose one strength from your list.
- Think of a time in your life when you showed that strength.
- Tell your partner what happened and what you did.



Read the **Areas to Improve** section for your personality type.
Choose one area that you would like to work on.
Write your area to improve below.

Why might this behaviour be a problem in a work place?

Make a goal to change this unwanted behaviour. What could you do instead?

Think of one thing you could do differently that would help you change.



Read the **Needs** section for your personality type.
Which needs relate to the kind of workplace you want?

Think of one time when you felt unhappy at work, in a volunteer job, with family, or with friends. What were you unhappy about?

How did you respond to this unhappy situation? Did you do any of the actions from the list called “When my needs aren’t met”?

What can you do next time your needs at work are not being met?



Interests Inventory



The Arts

Total Circled: _____



Social Services

Total Circled: _____



Business & Law

Total Circled: _____



Office Operations

Total Circled: _____



Crafts and Trades

Total Circled: _____



Science and Math

Total Circled: _____

[illegible][illegible]

Career Values Inventory

Your instructor will give you a set of career value cards. Sort them into three piles: Often Valued, Sometimes Valued, and Rarely Valued. Then record your answers below.

Often Valued

Sometimes Valued

Rarely Valued

Do My Values Match the Careers I'm Interested In?

1. Copy your top 5 values in the left side of the chart.
2. Write three careers you are most interested in along the top.
3. In the empty boxes, put a check for each value that matches a career option.
4. Put an X for each value that doesn't match a career option.

Top 5 Career Values	1.	2.	3.
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
Totals			

Which Career is the Best Match with your Values?

Skills Inventory

My Skill Set: _____

My Skills: Pick 1 - 3 skills on the card that describe you. Copy each skill into a box below.	Examples: Give at least one good example of a time you used this skill.

My Skill Set: _____

My Skills: Pick 1 - 3 skills on the card that describe you. Copy each skill into a box below.	Examples: Give at least one good example of a time you used this skill.

My Skill Set: _____

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My Skill Set: _____

My Skills: Pick 1 - 3 skills on the card that describe you. Copy each skill into a box below.	Examples: Give at least one good example of a time you used this skill.

My Skill Set: _____

My Skills: Pick 1 - 3 skills on the card that describe you. Copy each skill into a box below.	Examples: Give at least one good example of a time you used this skill.

My Goals

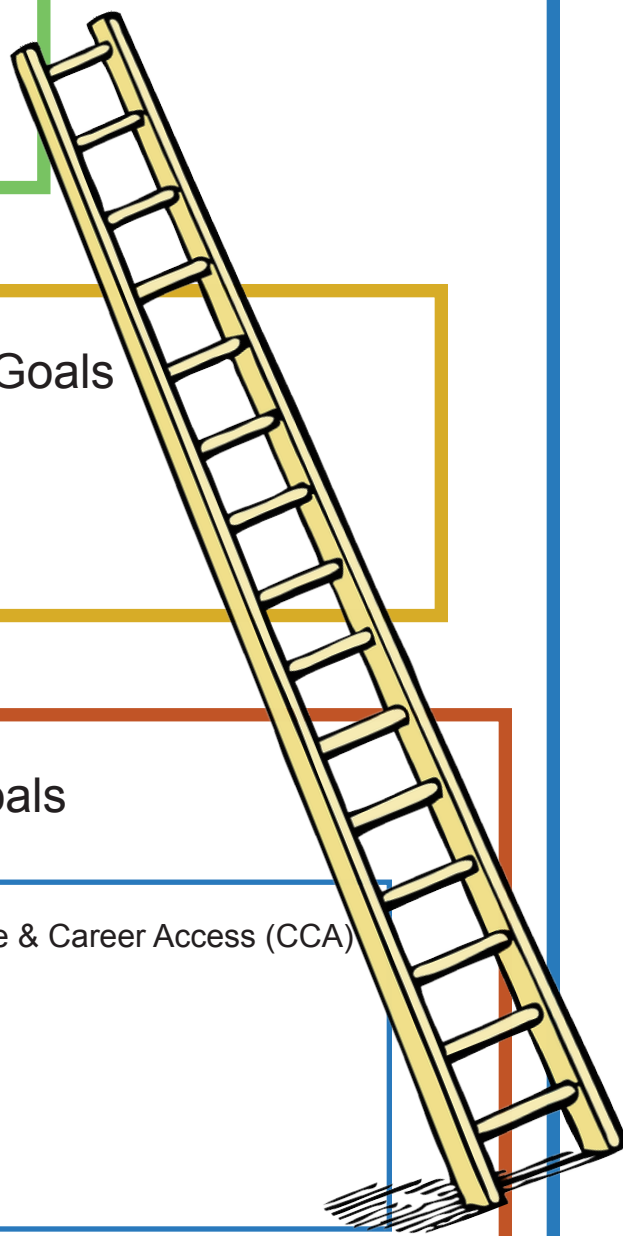
My Career Goal

My Career Education Goals

My Upgrading Goals

Basic Education

College & Career Access (CCA)



VANCOUVER
COMMUNITY
COLLEGE